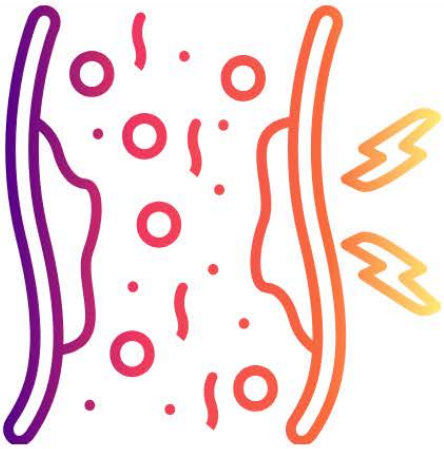
Benchmark Diagnostics

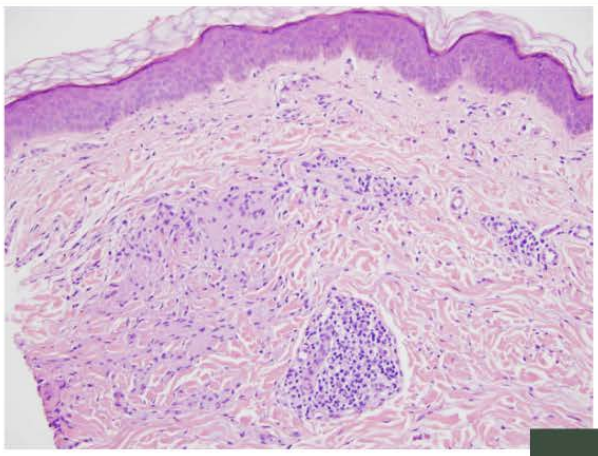
Notes from Benchmark

Clinical Pearls • New Evidence • Interesting Cases

Granuloma Annulare and Metabolic Screening

Vol 1 | Issue 2 | February 2026







Granuloma Annulare: Dyslipidemia and Type-2 Diabetes

Granuloma annulare (GA) is a common palisading granulomatous dermatosis. Its association with dyslipidemia and type 2 diabetes mellitus has been suggested.

Recently, multiple studies, including a 2025 case-control study from a tertiary center (30 histopathologically confirmed GA patients vs. matched controls), have confirmed a higher prevalence of dyslipidemia in GA cases, with annular morphology particularly associated with hypercholesterolemia. Large cohort data (e.g., the 2021 JAMA Dermatology population-based study of over 5,000 GA patients) reinforced that baseline hyperlipidemia and diabetes are risk factors for GA development, and some cases show lesion improvement with lipid control.

Clinical Pearls

- Just as necrobiosis lipoidica, granuloma annulare is also associated with metabolic deregulation
- Testing for HbA1c and lipid profile may be warranted in GA patients if unknown
- Some patients may improve with return to baseline lipid levels
- Ring-variant is associated with hypercholesterolemia
- Associated conditions may also include autoimmune disorders and hematologic malignancies

Barbieri JS, Rosenbach M, Rodriguez O, Margolis DJ. Association of Granuloma Annulare With Type 2 Diabetes, Hyperlipidemia, Autoimmune Disorders, and Hematologic Malignant Neoplasms. JAMA Dermatol. 2021 Jul 1;157(7):817-823. doi: 10.1001/jamadermatol.2021.1805. PMID: 34106218; PMCID: PMC8190702.

"Questions or cases to discuss? We're always happy to review."